

Now and Next Board

A free printable visual support for transitions

A Now and Next board shows a child what is happening now and what comes next — one step at a time. For many autistic children and children with additional needs, being able to see the next step (instead of only being told) reduces the anxiety around transitions and cuts down on repeated prompts.

How to use it

Choose the board that suits your child — Now & Next (two steps) or Now, Next & Then (three steps).

Print the activity cards on the last pages, cut them out, and laminate if you can. Add a small hook-and-loop (Velcro) dot to each card and each box so cards can be swapped.

Put the current activity in “Now” and the next one in “Next”. When “Now” is finished, move “Next” across and add a new card.

Keeep the language simple and consistent: “Now bath, next pyjamas.”

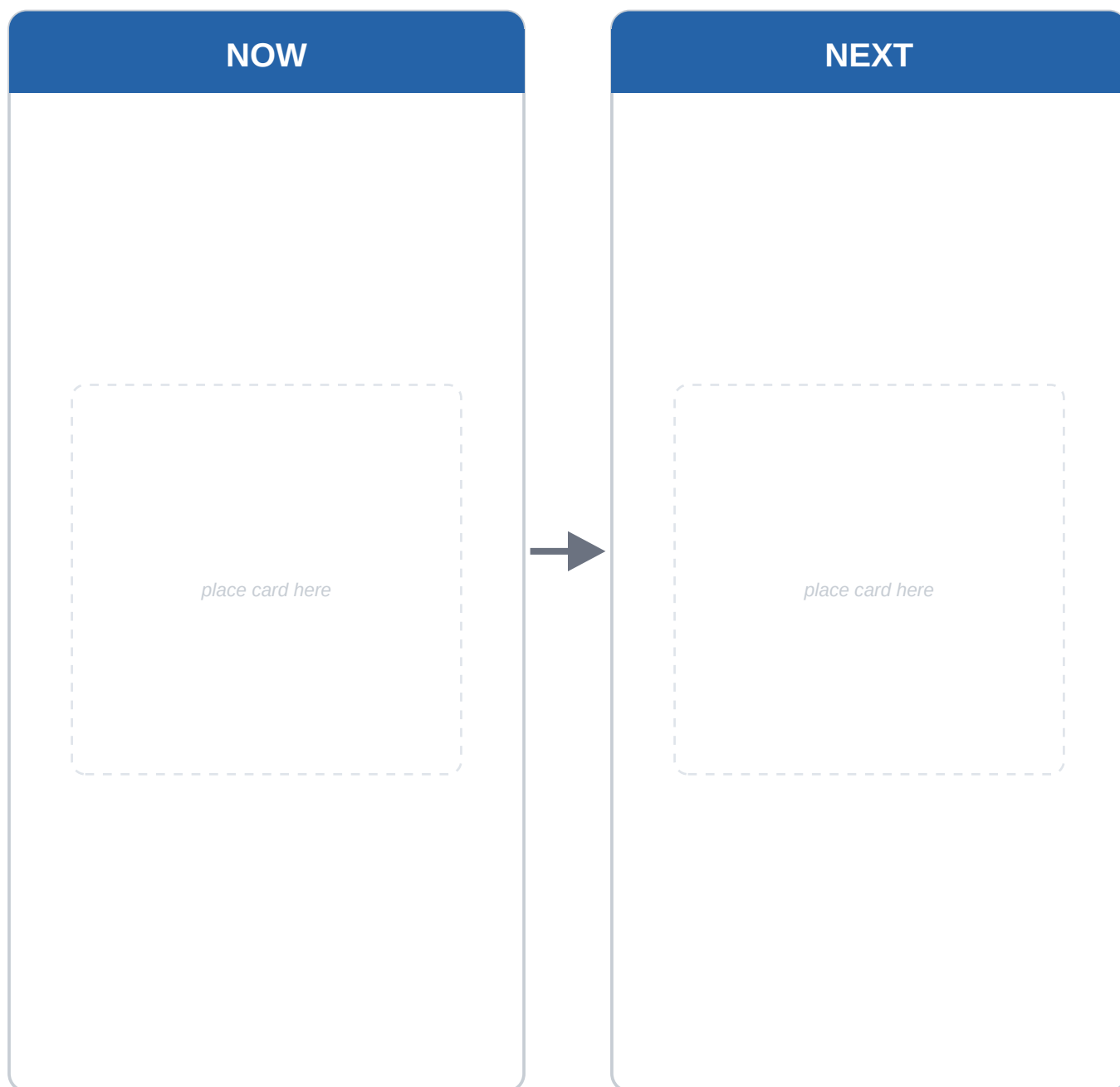
Start with a motivating “next” so the board feels positive, not just a list of demands.

Tip

The boxes are deliberately blank — write on them, use the cut-out cards, or add your own photos. There's a ready-made bedtime example on the next-but-one page.

Now and Next

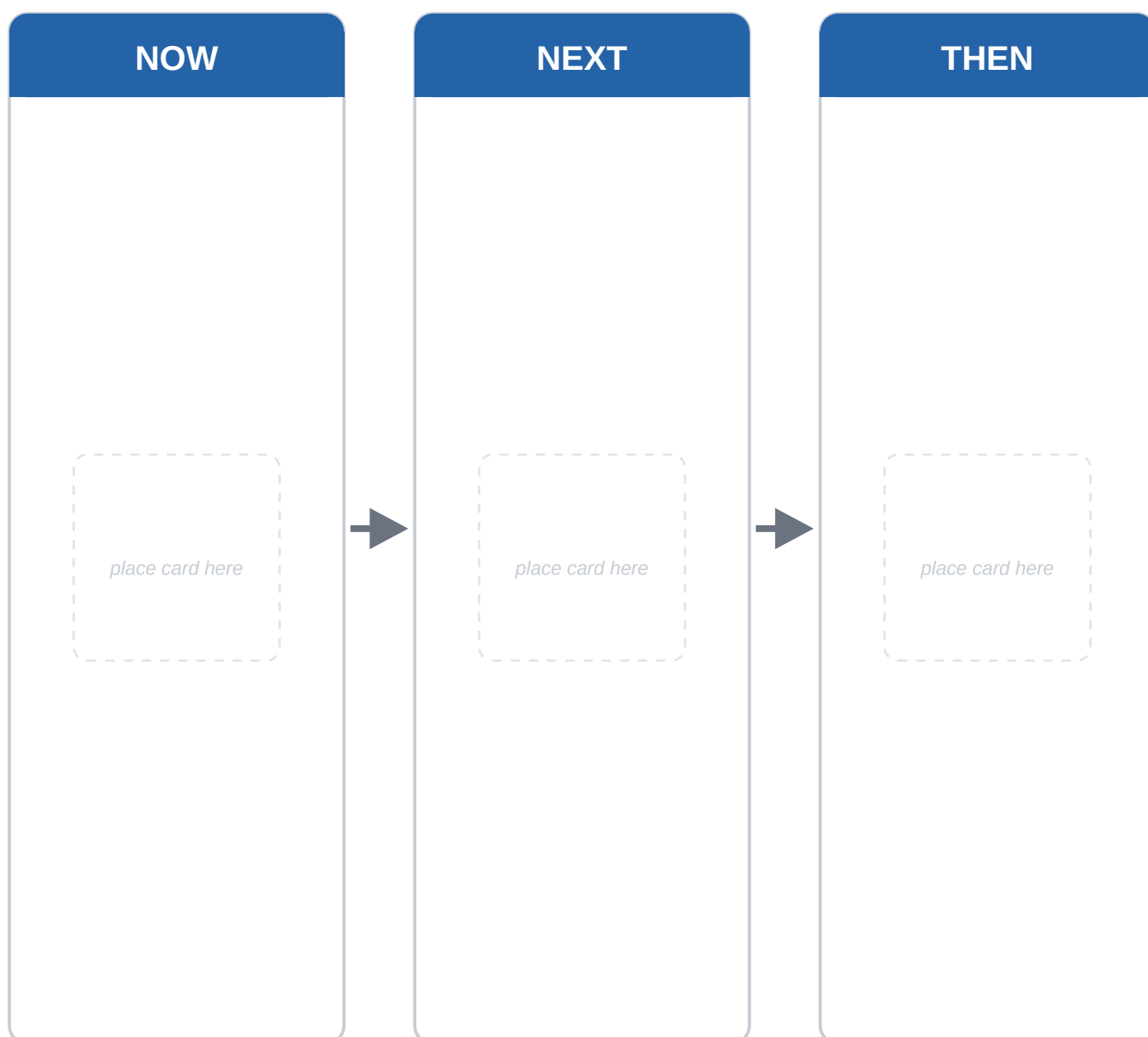
Two steps — what's happening now, and what comes next



Print the cards, cut out, and add a hook-and-loop (Velcro) dot to swap them in and out.

Now, Next and Then

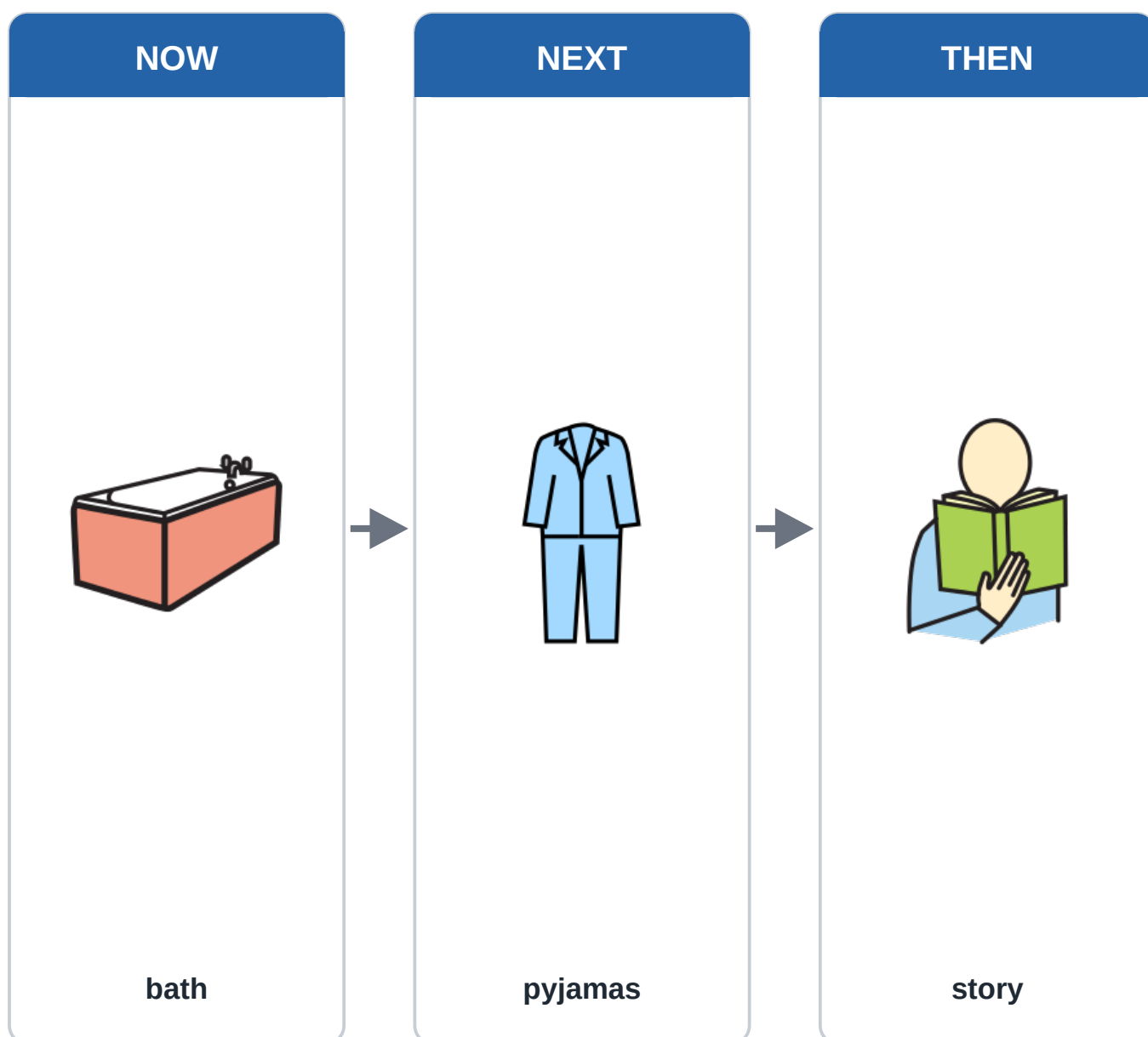
Three steps — for slightly longer sequences



Print the cards, cut out, and add a hook-and-loop (Velcro) dot to swap them in and out.

Bedtime — an example

Now, Next and Then, filled in for a bath-time routine



Print the cards, cut out, and add a hook-and-loop (Velcro) dot to swap them in and out.



breakfast



lunch



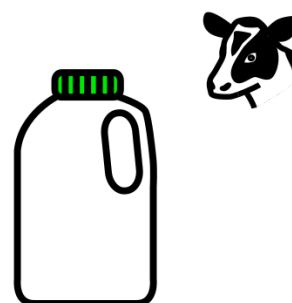
dinner



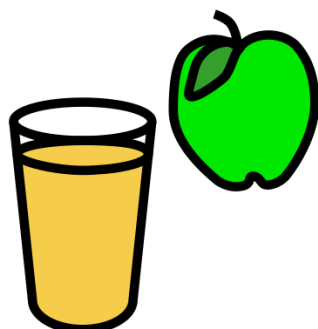
drink



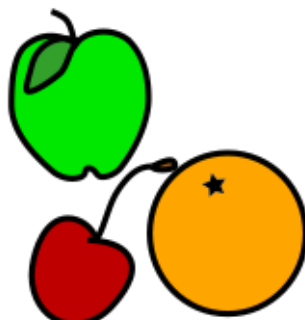
water



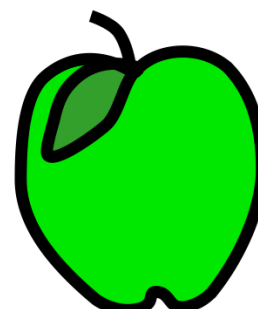
milk



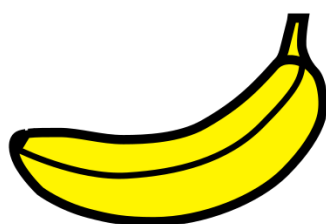
juice



fruit



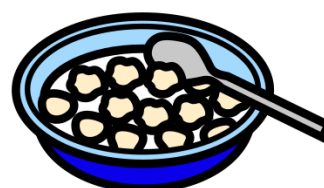
apple



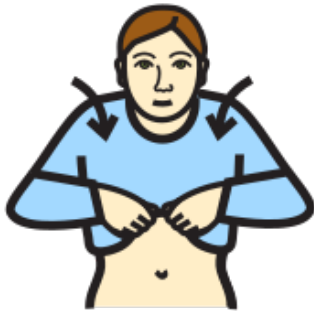
banana



toast



cereal



get dressed



brush teeth



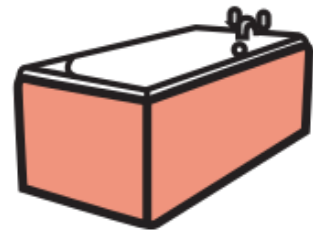
wash hands



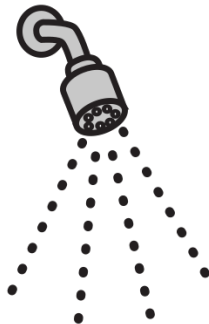
wash face



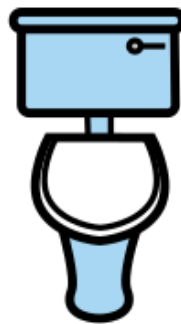
brush hair



bath



shower



toilet



potty



pyjamas



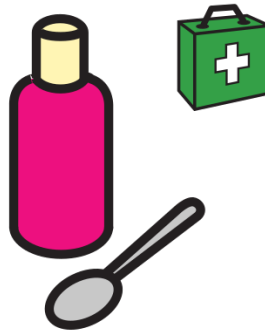
coat



shoes



socks



medicine



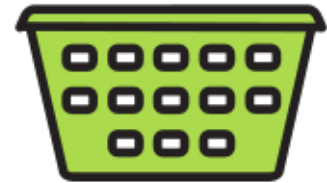
tidy up



make bed



wash up



laundry



hoover



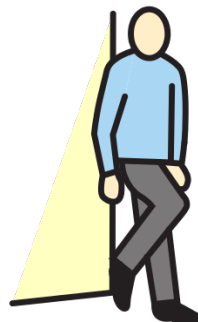
feed the dog



cooking



help



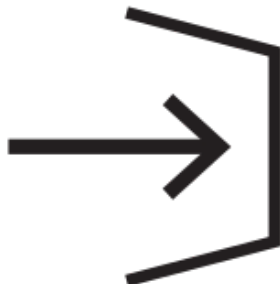
wait



sit down



stand up



finished



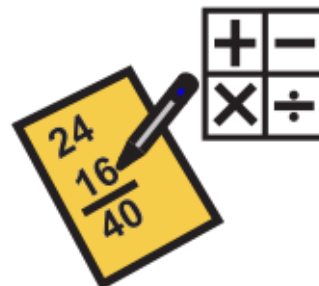
school



writing



reading



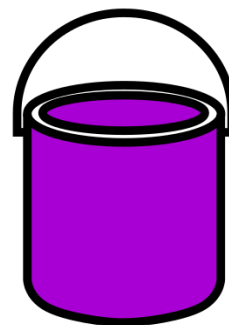
maths

1 2 3 4

counting



drawing



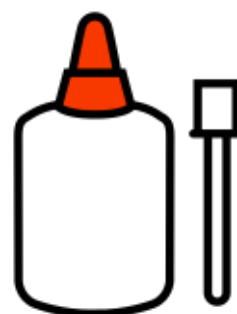
painting



colouring



cutting



glue



exercise



assembly



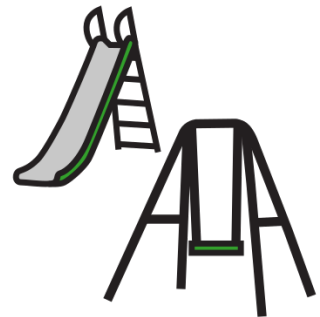
music



computer



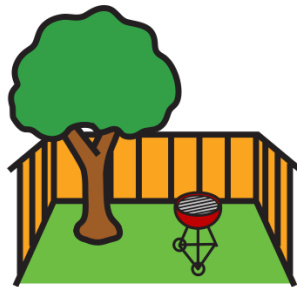
play



playground



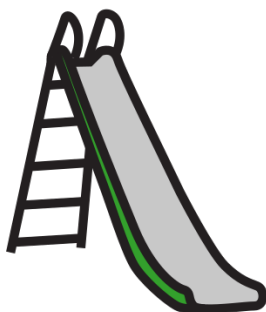
outside



garden



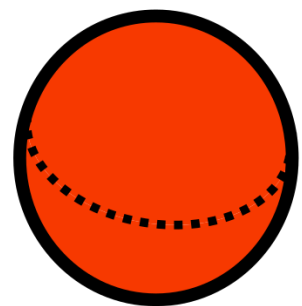
swing



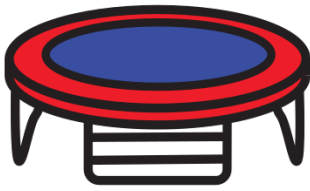
slide



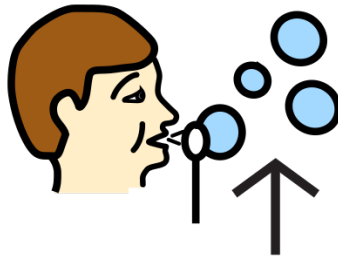
bike



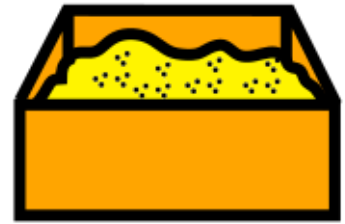
ball



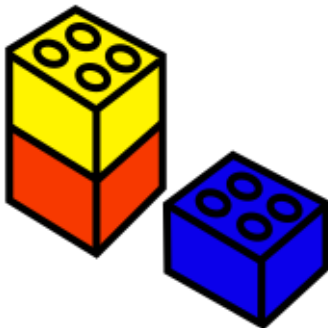
trampoline



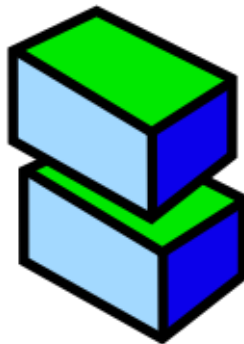
bubbles



sand pit



lego



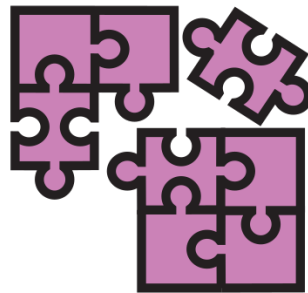
blocks



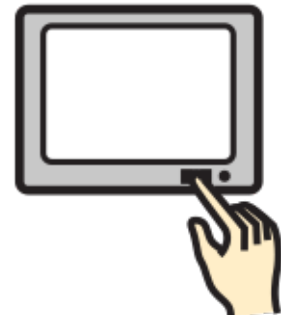
dancing



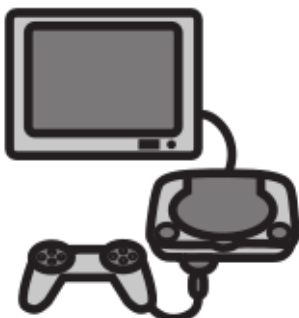
singing



puzzle



TV



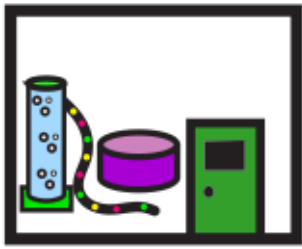
game



quiet



relax



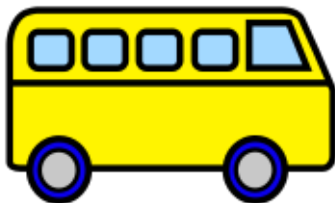
sensory room



hug



car



bus



train



walk



shop



swimming



cafe



doctor



dentist



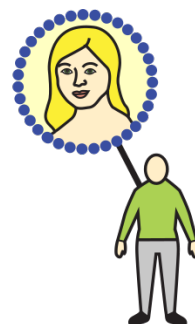
jump



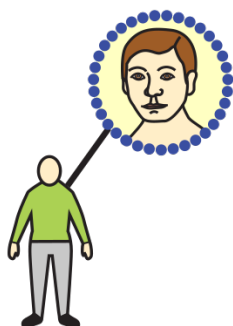
run



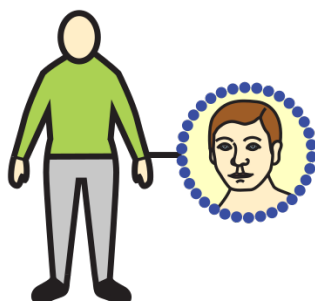
clap



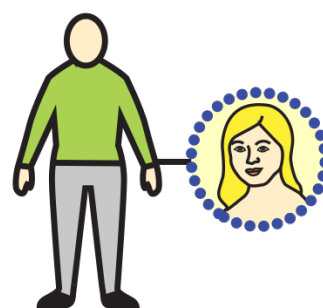
mum



dad



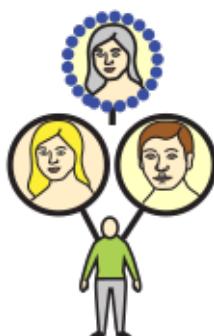
brother



sister



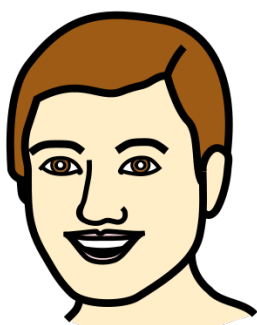
baby



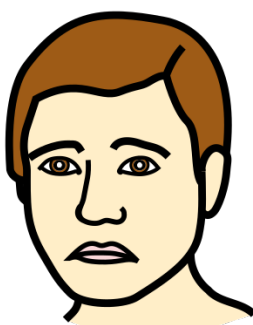
grandma



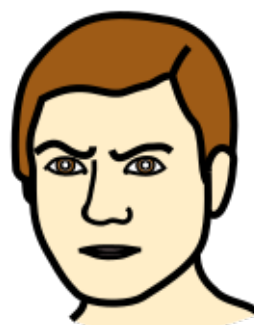
teacher



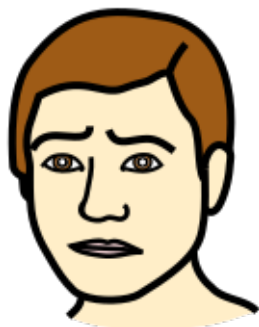
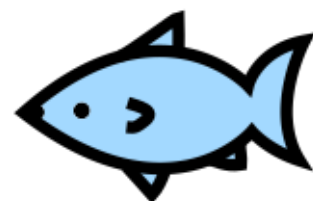
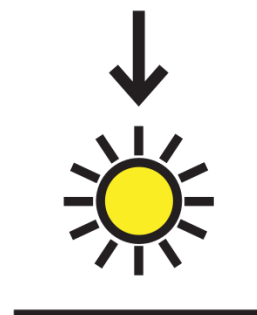
happy



sad



angry

**worried****tired****dog****cat****rabbit****fish****morning****night****today****bed****sleep**